

Duo-Dote

(Pralidoxime chloride and atropine sulfate)

I. Classification

- Antidote

II. Action(s)

- Atropine counters effect of nerve agents / organophosphates by blocking the effects of acetylcholine at the nerve receptor level
- Pralidoxime reactivates acetylcholinesterase, which breaks down excess acetylcholine, therefore restoring normal cholinergic nerve function

III. Indication(s)

- Nerve agent poisoning (sarin, soman, tabun, VX, etc.)
- Organophosphate poisoning

IV. Contraindications

- None

V. Precautions

- None

VI. Drug interactions

- None significant enough to prevent use when needed

VII. Adult Dosing and Administration

- 1-3 auto-injectors IM in outer quadrant of thigh
- Dose dependent on severity of signs/symptoms (1 for mild symptoms, 2 for moderate symptoms, 3 for severe symptoms)

VIII. Pediatric Dosing and Administration

- Same as adult

IX. Onset

- Immediate

X. Duration

- varies by patient's age and metabolism

XI. Possible Adverse Effects

- Allergic reaction
- Dilated pupils / dry mouth / decreased sweating / dry skin / urinary retention
- Tachycardia / atrial fibrillation / PVCs / palpitations / V-fib
- Tachypnea
- Hypertension

XII. Other Notes

- Inject into outer quadrant of thigh only – hold in place for 10 seconds